血里的指纹

The Fingerprint in the Blood



DNA为何先替无辜者洗清嫌疑?

英文原文

In November 1983 a 15-year-old girl was murdered in the Leicestershire village of Narborough, and the **homicide** went **unsolved**. In the summer of 1986 a second 15-year-old was **slain** near **neighbouring** Enderby. A 17-year-old local youth **confessed** to the second killing, and to **detectives** the **perplexing investigation** was **seemingly resolved**.

The **revelation** had come two years **previously**. On 10 September 1984 Alec Jeffreys, a **geneticist** at the University of Leicester, **discerned** on an X-ray film **molecular markers** whose **layout varied considerably** from person to person. He called them DNA fingerprints, since, like fingerprints, they **differentiated** individuals. The journal Nature **promptly** carried his paper in March 1985.

Police **enlisted** Jeffreys, and his **genetic** tests **overturned** the **erroneous confession**. The youth was not the **perpetrator**, and the same **attacker** had killed both girls. The youth became the first person known to be cleared by DNA evidence. The **forensic innovation** had freed an **innocent** before it **implicated** anyone.

In January 1987 police **commenced** the world's first **large-scale** DNA **screening**, asking more than 5,000 men in three villages for blood or **saliva**. None matched. The **elusive** killer, a local **baker**, had **induced** a **co-worker** to give a sample in his name, **evading suspicion**. In August 1987 someone **overheard** the **co-worker** discussing the **substitution** and **notified** police.

Colin Pitchfork was **detained** on 19 September 1987, and his DNA **profile** matched. In January 1988 he **pleaded** guilty and was **jailed** for life, the first person **convicted of** murder on the basis of DNA evidence. A **tip-off**, not the screening, had **unmasked** him. The test's first **beneficiary** had been a **blameless juvenile** who had **falsely** admitted the **offence**.

中文译文

1983年11月，一名15岁的女孩在莱斯特郡的纳伯勒村遇害，这起凶杀案一直未能侦破。1986年夏天，又一名15岁的女孩在邻近的恩德比附近被杀害。一名17岁的当地青年供认了第二起命案，在警探看来，这场扑朔迷离的调查似乎已经了结。

这个意外发现，早在两年以前就已经出现了。1984年9月10日，亚历克·杰弗里斯，一位遗传学家在莱斯特大学（任职），在一张X光片上辨认出一些分子标记，这些标记的排布在人与人之间相差相当大。他把这些标记称为DNA指纹，因为像指纹一样，它们能把不同的人区分开来。《自然》期刊很快就在1985年3月刊登了他的论文。

警方请来了杰弗里斯，他的基因检测推翻了那份错误的供词。那名青年不是行凶者，而且是同一个袭击者杀害了这两名女孩。这名青年成为已知第一个凭DNA证据被证明清白的人。这项法医学创新早已让一名无辜者重获自由，在它牵连到任何人之前。

1987年1月，警方开始了世界上首次大规模的DNA筛查，请三个村庄的5,000多名男子提供血液或唾液。没有一份样本吻合。这个难以找到的凶手，一名当地的面包师，事先诱使一名同事冒他的名字提供了样本，躲过了怀疑。1987年8月，有人无意中听到这名同事在谈论冒名顶替的事，并通知了警方。

科林·皮奇福克在1987年9月19日被拘留，他的DNA图谱（与凶手的）吻合。1988年1月，他承认有罪并被终身监禁，（成为）第一个依据DNA证据被判谋杀罪的人。是一条举报，而不是那次筛查，揭穿了他的真面目。这项检测的第一个受益者是一名清白的少年，他曾虚假地认下这项罪行。

词汇与表达

homicide n.
凶杀案
and the homicide went unsolved.

unsolved adj.
未能侦破

slain v.
杀害

neighbouring adj.
邻近的

confessed v.
供认了
confessed to the second killing

detectives n.
警探

perplexing adj.
扑朔迷离的

investigation n.
调查
the perplexing investigation

seemingly adv.
似乎

resolved v.
了结

revelation n.
意外发现

previously adv.
以前

geneticist n.
遗传学家
a geneticist

discerned v.
辨认出
discerned on an X-ray film

molecular adj.
分子
molecular markers

markers n.
标记

layout n.
排布

varied v.
相差
layout varied considerably

considerably adv.
相当大

词汇与表达（续）

differentiated v.
区分
they differentiated individuals.

promptly adv.
很快

enlisted v.
请来了

genetic adj.
基因

overturned v.
推翻了
overturned the erroneous confession.

erroneous adj.
错误的
the erroneous confession.

confession n.
供词

perpetrator n.
行凶者
The youth was not the perpetrator,

attacker n.
袭击者

forensic adj.
法医学
The forensic innovation

innovation n.
创新
The forensic innovation

innocent n.
无辜者
had freed an innocent

implicated v.
牵连
before it implicated anyone.

commenced v.
开始了
In January 1987 police commenced

large-scale adj.
大规模的

screening n.
筛查
large-scale DNA screening, asking more than 5,000

saliva n.
唾液

elusive adj.
难以找到的
The elusive killer, a local baker,

词汇与表达（续）

baker n.
面包师
killer, a local baker, had induced a co-worker

induced v.
诱使
had induced a co-worker

co-worker n.
同事

evading v.
躲过了

suspicion n.
怀疑

overheard v.
无意中听到

substitution n.
冒名顶替
discussing the substitution

notified v.
通知了

detained v.
拘留

profile n.
图谱
his DNA profile matched.

pleaded v.
承认

jailed v.
监禁

convicted of v.
被判……罪
the first person convicted of murder on the basis

tip-off n.
举报
A tip-off, not the screening,

unmasked v.
揭穿了

beneficiary n.
受益者
The test's first beneficiary

blameless adj.
清白的

juvenile n.
少年

falsely adv.
虚假地

offence n.
罪行

文章简述

- 发现：杰弗里斯发现，人体DNA中的一些遗传标记排列因人而异，可以像手指指纹一样区分不同的人，因此提出DNA指纹技术。
- 洗冤：两名少女遇害后，一名少年供认第二起命案；警方请杰弗里斯检验，发现少年并非凶手，两案却出自同一人。
- 漏网：警方随后向五千多名男子收集血液或唾液，开展大规模DNA筛查，却没有找到吻合者，因为真凶让同事冒名提供了样本。
- 破案：有人听见同事谈论顶替采样并举报，警方循线逮捕皮奇福克，核对DNA后确认身份；皮奇福克认罪，被判终身监禁。
- 意义：这项技术先让一名作了虚假供认的无辜少年获释，后来才帮助判定真凶有罪；揭穿冒名靠的是举报，DNA则为身份认定提供了证据。